Chapter 2: Economic Activities, Sectors & Resource Management

Class 8 - Social Science | Unit: Resources and Development (Geography & Economics)

CHAPTER OVERVIEW & CORE FOUNDATIONAL CONCEPTS

Examines economic classification into primary, secondary, and tertiary sectors alongside land use patterns, soils, and sustainable development.

KEY LEARNING OBJECTIVES

1. Distinguish between primary (agriculture, mining), secondary (manufacturing), and tertiary (services) sectors.
2. Understand soil profile layers and soil conservation techniques (contour plowing, terrace farming, shelterbelts).
3. Analyze factors influencing agricultural crop patterns: climate, topography, soil fertility, and technology.

1. SECTORS OF THE ECONOMY

Primary activities directly extract natural resources (farming, fishing). Secondary activities process raw materials into manufactured finished goods (weaving cotton into textiles). Tertiary activities provide services supporting production and trade (transport, banking, healthcare).

2. SOIL DEGRADATION AND SCIENTIFIC CONSERVATION

Overgrazing, deforestation, chemical fertilizers, and rain-wash cause soil erosion. Conservation methods include terrace farming on mountain slopes, contour bunding to retard water runoff, and planting tree shelterbelts in dry regions.

DIAGNOSTIC FOCUS & COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS

Students frequently struggle to categorize hybrid economic tasks, such as classifying food packaging or agricultural grain transport into secondary versus tertiary sectors.

PREREQUISITE REINFORCEMENT QUESTIONS

Q1: Differentiate between primary and secondary economic sectors with one example each.

Expected Answer: Primary sector involves natural resource extraction (e.g. wheat farming); secondary sector transforms raw commodities into manufactured goods (e.g. baking bread in a factory).

Q2: Explain how terrace farming prevents soil erosion in mountainous terrains.

Expected Answer: Broad flat steps or terraces cut into steep slopes reduce the velocity of surface water runoff, preserving topsoil from being washed away.